

Compared to traditional batteries, these batteries can be broken in organised recycling plants under much safer environmental conditions. Almost all of the materials are recyclable, hence their disposal is environment-friendly. The materials that can be recycled include lead, electrolyte, plastic, steel and copper (not in automotive batteries).

However, lead being a hazardous

We use inter-cell weld of inner cell, which provides a very low-resistance current path

—Rajesh Gupta, director, Okaya Power



material, proper care needs to be taken by the user during its disposal. The scrap batteries should be given only to government-authorised smelters having proper infrastructure for recycling the lead. The government has mandated that the used batteries have to be purchased back by the seller.

Exide claims to have complete infrastructure for 100 per cent recycling of lead.

"Using zero-discharge facilities in our manufacturing setup itself, from

Our new technology will help in reducing the carbon footprint

—Sushil Jiwarajka, chairman, Artheon Group



will certainly help in reducing the carbon footprint," informs Sushil Jiwarajka, chairman, Artheon Group.

The road ahead

The two per cent increase in excise duty will increase the price of the battery. However, with increase in the GDP growth, the future for the battery industry seems to be bright, with growth rate maintained at 25 per cent in years to come.

Base ensures that all of harmful ingredients are recycled in the best possible machines, and reused, based on the purity

—Aditya Arora, marketing head, Base Corporation



VRLA batteries are sensitive to charging parameters and depth of discharge, and if proper care and maintenance in terms of sizing and running the battery are not taken, there is a chance of failure

—Tarit Kumar Roy, general manager-institutional UPS, telecom, railways, solar, Exide Industries

the time the batteries leave after manufacturing till they return for recycling, Base ensures that all of their harmful ingredients are recycled in the best possible machines, and reused, based on the purity," says Arora.

Artheon is working on a next-generation technology along with its joint-venture partner. This new technology will help in reducing the charging time as well as enhance the life of the battery. "We are sure this new technology

The government should give more incentive to the organised sector investing in high-efficiency, green battery technologies so that the same can be manufactured at a lower cost. The future definitely belongs to greener battery technologies due to worldwide environmental concerns. In electric vehicles, the next decade will witness rapid advancements and switchover to lithium-ion and fuel cell technologies.

The focus on infrastructure and the push being given to the renewable energy sector will substantially increase demand for batteries in the year ahead. ●

The author is a deputy editor at EFY